

Recruiting for Medlyfe

A full-time COO and a health coach. How to engage.

Two searches, and they are not the same search twice. The COO is a commercial hire who carries the Medlyfe P&L, drawn from a market of general managers and divisional operators who are almost all currently employed and not looking. The health coach is a specialist hire who carries the client relationship day to day, drawn from a younger and much shallower pool where the few strong practitioners are usually already placed. Different markets, different timelines, and different work to reach them.

Both are retained, and both produce the same thing: three or four candidates mapped, approached and interviewed against your brief, assessed for how they lead rather than only for what they have done, with references and credentials verified before you meet anyone. **The fee on each is 15% of first-year total package.** What follows is how that is paid, what it covers, what happens if a hire does not work, and the single step needed to start.

01 / THE TWO ROLES

What each mandate is.

Role	Basis	What the person owns	Timeline
Chief Operating Officer, Medlyfe	Full time, permanent	Owns the Medlyfe P&L, on the same basis as the leads of Hospitals, Pharmaceuticals and Diagnostics. Revenue, margin and growth, with clinical operations, quality and compliance, and the team reporting in. Answers to the Group Chief Executive	8 to 10 weeks to offer
Health coach, Medlyfe	Full time, permanent	Owns the client relationship across programmes: goal setting, behaviour change, adherence, and the handover between the physician, the nutritionist and the client	4 to 6 weeks to offer

The COO joins the divisional leads as a peer, and that sets the bar. Three consequences worth naming before the search opens. The search is for a commercial operator rather than a clinical operations manager, because the person carries revenue and margin, which is a materially smaller pool. The package has to be competitive against divisional general management rather than against clinical administration, and the benchmark we bring to the scoping call will reflect that. And because divisional leads at Medbury are given genuine autonomy, **this hire has to be someone capable of running independently from the first quarter**, not someone who needs to be managed into the role. That last point is the one that most often decides whether an operator hire works, and it is what the assessment on the shortlist is designed to test.

02 / THE FEE

What it costs, and when it is paid.

Mandate	Fee rate	Minimum fee, NGN M
Chief Operating Officer, Medlyfe	15%	4.5
Health coach, Medlyfe	15%	1.8
Both mandates together		6.3

Total package means base salary plus guaranteed allowances and any guaranteed bonus for the first twelve months. It excludes discretionary bonus, equity and benefits in kind. Where 15% of the agreed package exceeds the minimum, the percentage applies; where it falls below, the minimum applies.

Payment

Tranche	Share	Note
On engagement	40%	Payable before the search opens. It funds the search team, the package benchmark and the mapping work
On delivery of the shortlist	30%	Three to four assessed candidates, with written profiles and a leadership assessment on each
On acceptance of offer	30%	Payable when the candidate signs, not when they start

A structured leadership assessment on every shortlisted candidate is included at no additional charge. For a COO it is the part that matters most, because the failure mode in an operator hire is rarely technical. It is judgement, temperament and the ability to hold a team through a difficult quarter, and an interview does not surface any of the three reliably.

03 / WHAT THE FEE COVERS

And what it does not.

	Item
Included	Role scoping, an evidenced package benchmark, and the written brief
Included	Market mapping and direct approach, including senior Nigerians working abroad where the role suits a returner
Included	Screening, competency interviewing, and a structured leadership assessment on the shortlist
Included	Reference and credential verification, including regulatory standing where the role is clinical
Included	Offer construction, negotiation support, and a thirty-day check-in after the start date
Not included	Candidate travel and relocation, and any pre-employment medical. Reimbursed at cost if incurred
Not included	Advertising in paid media, if Medbury wants it. Agreed in advance and reimbursed at cost with no commission

The guarantee

If the person resigns or is dismissed for cause within six months of starting, CFA re-runs the search for the balance of out-of-pocket costs only. No second fee. The condition is that the role, the package and the reporting line are unchanged. It is the term that puts the risk of a wrong hire where it belongs, which is with the firm that recommended the person.

04 / THE GAP IN THE MEANTIME

Optional, and worth considering for the COO only.

A COO search runs eight to ten weeks to offer, and a candidate of that seniority will owe one to three months of notice, so realistically the seat is filled around month four. If Medlyfe cannot carry that gap, CFA can second an experienced operator into the role while the permanent search runs.

Option	Rate	What it is
Interim operations lead, seconded from CFA	NGN 3M a month, six months minimum, NGN 18M	Full time on site. Holds the operating rhythm, the reporting and the team, and hands over to the permanent COO with the work in progress rather than in a folder

Six months is the minimum because a shorter secondment does not repay itself. An interim spends the first month learning the business and the last handing it over, so three months buys one useful month. Six buys a full operating quarter in the middle, and it covers the search, the successful candidate's notice period, and a proper overlap once they arrive. **It also produces a far better brief for the permanent search**, because the role ends up defined by what the clinic actually needs rather than by what an organogram says it should be.

Entirely optional, and the permanent search proceeds either way. There is a question on the brief form for it.

05 / HOW IT STARTS

Fill the brief. Everything else follows from it.

There is no separate paperwork to sign. **The brief form is the instruction to proceed**, and submitting it authorises the search on the terms in this note. It also has to come first, because the fee is a percentage of the package and we cannot invoice a number the brief has not yet stated.

consultforafrica.com/recruitment/brief

Open the brief and start the search

Five steps, about ten minutes. Submit once for the COO and again for the health coach.

Step	What happens
1 You complete the brief, once per role	Accountability, person specification, package and process. The two answers that matter most are whether the role owns a P&L and what the package is, because between them they decide who we can credibly approach
2 We invoice the engagement tranche	Within one working day. 40% of the fee, calculated on the package in your brief, and non-refundable
3 The search opens on receipt of funds	Not before. You then have a written brief and an evidenced package benchmark to approve within three working days
4 Shortlist, then offer	30% of the fee falls due on delivery of the shortlist and 30% on acceptance of offer

If a field is not yet settled, submit your best answer and flag it in the notes. It is faster to correct one line at the scoping call than to hold the search waiting for certainty on a package range.

On the wider work, Medbury Aesthetics and the SPVs, the medipark, and the conversion centre: that comes to you as its own note so this one is not held up behind it.

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The fee is calculated on the package stated in your brief. Where 15% of it falls below the minimum for the role, the minimum applies. We bring an evidenced package benchmark to the scoping call, so the level is set against the market rather than against an assumption. Timelines are to offer and exclude the candidate's notice period. Not a binding offer, and not legal advice.